

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2021

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 51)

- 2.1: (max 36)
 - 1 point for each correct language (H or D). (max 12)
 - 2 points for each correct translation (A-F). (max 24)
- 2.2: 3 points for each correct English sentence. (max 15)
 - 2 points with one error (one wrong word or wrong syntactic role assignment)
 - 1 point with two such errors.
 - Accept
 - *will Verb for Verb.*
 - *him/he/his for her/she*
 - *father for the father* – but not *the father for her father*
 - *end for edge*
 - *come down for descends*

Q2.1.

#	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
H/D	D	H	D	D	H	H	D	D	H	H	H	D
A-F	F	D	B	E	A	F	D	A	E	C	B	C

Q2.2.

Hawu or Dhao	English
Ra pa'èra ama	They strengthened the father. or: They made the father strong.
Ki pedutu roo ri ama no, pedute noo ri roo	If her father follows (them), they (will) follow (her).
Pebèlu roo ri noo	She made them forget.
Ladhe na puru, na nèdhi sebhe	If she descends, she sees the edge.
B'ole bèj'i	Don't sleep/lie down/be asleep.

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Commentary

First, let's learn a little more about Hawu and Dhao history and culture. It's nice to get some broader context, and it also shows respect for the people who speak and who have historically spoken the languages presented in this problem.

Today the majority of Hawu people practise Protestant Christianity, but until the 1970s most of the Hawu people maintained their ancestral religion, Jingi Tiu, and traditional ways of life. In pre-colonial times, the Hawu people maintained six religio-political domains on the island of Hawu (Savu), including the domain of Seba (after which the modern-day Seba, mentioned in the problem, is named). Each domain had a Council of Priests (of Jingi Tiu). These domains were reorganized during and after the colonial era until a 2001 autonomy law, which the East Nusa Tenggara province used to create new districts that largely reflected the structure of the ancient domains. The Hawu people traditionally transmitted their knowledge orally in a number of ways, for example by naming places in remembrance of key events in Hawu history and naming people by the roles they played in society. The Hawu remember long genealogies over tens of generations that have links at certain stages to the various parts of Hawu island. They recognize two matrilineal lines descended from two sisters as well as patrilineal descent groups and lineages. These genealogies structure Hawu society and are recited during ritual performances; for example, at funerals the reciting of the departed's genealogy memorializes the connection of the departed to his or her ancestors.

Source: Duggan, G. (2009). The Genealogical Model of Savu, Eastern Indonesia. *Journal of Indonesian Social Sciences and Humanities*, 2, 163–177. LIPI / KITLV Press.

<https://web.archive.org/web/20120302193735/http://www.kitlv-journals.nl/index.php/ijslh/article/viewFile/URN:NBN:NL:UI:10-1-100162/8444>

The Dhao people say their language and culture is similar to that of Hawu island. They recount that the first settlers of their island were three people named Rika, Jote, and Pesa Kèli. Pesa Kèli came from the island of Hawu and brought the indigo plant, dhao, from which Dhao (Ndao) island and the Dhao people get their names. (The Hawu also tell a version of this history.) Traditionally, many Dhao men practiced gold- and silversmithing, traveling around the region to sell their creations. Today, most Dhao men have shifted away from smithing to fishing and local business activities. Women traditionally wove fabrics dyed with a technique known as ikat and are still productive in ikat weaving today. They leave their homes to sell their products, to seek orders for new weavings, or to collect debts from their customers. Thousands of jewels and ikats are produced each year and are traded with neighboring islands. The men tend to leave the island during the dry season to sell jewelry and other products of smithing and the ikat weaving products made by the women. In contrast to the Hawu, the Dhao trace their descent only patrilineally.

Source: Balukh, J. I. (2020). *A grammar of Dhao: An endangered Austronesian language in Eastern Indonesia*. <https://scholarlypublications.universiteitleiden.nl/access/item%3A2967898/view>

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Solution to the problem

Sound correspondences (identified using the table at the beginning):

Hawu	Dhao
a	a
n	n
t	t
e	a
l	l
o	o/u
r	r
b	bh
è	è
j'	j'
i	i (but e in dedha)
b'	b
h	s
d	dh
d'	d
u	u
p	p (but bh in subha , m in madhutu)

Using the differences between Hawu and Dhao shown in the above table, we can figure out which sentences in (1-12) are in Hawu and which are in Dhao. For example, **s** is a sound unique to Dhao, so any sentence with an **s** will be in Dhao. Then we can match the six sentences in Hawu and the six sentences in Dhao to their translations and analyze the grammar.

Hawu grammar (simplified for this problem)

Dhao grammar (simplified for this problem)

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word order: either Verb (Object) Subject (Prepositional Phrase) or V S (O) (PP) - in this problem, pronoun objects were only used in VOS order tense/aspect/mood: ta V = non-past tense; otherwise the default interpretation is past tense ke in this problem always appears immediately following ta V - V ... teruu = <i>keep Ving, continue to V</i> b'ole V = <i>don't V</i> verbs: - verbs have specific forms that agree with the absolutive-marked noun phrase in number pebèlo = absolutive NP is singular; pebèlu = absolutive NP is plural pedute/pedutu nèru/nèru pe-V = <i>to cause to V</i> (so we call pe- a <i>causative</i> prefix) - this changes an intransitive verb to a transitive verb - so hewina = <i>remember</i>, pehewina = <i>remind</i> (not in UKLO problem) Note: In the problem, pebèlo/pebèlu was translated as <i>make to forget</i>, but in actual Hawu usage, this verb means something more like <i>forget on purpose</i>. pronouns:	word order: S V (O) (PP) only tense/aspect/mood: - no visible tense-marking - V ... taruu = <i>keep Ving, continue to V</i> baku V = <i>don't V</i> verbs: pa-V = <i>to cause to V</i> - another example: puru = <i>descend</i>, papuru = <i>lower (something)</i> èra = <i>(to be) strong</i>, pa'èra = <i>strengthen</i> pronouns:
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- **noo** = 3SG, *she* (or *he*) → **no** = *her* (or *his*)
- **roo** = 3PL, *they* → **ro** = *their*

Noun Phrases:

- **ne** marks the object of a transitive verb and the subject of an intransitive verb (this is called *absolutive case*), as well as the predicate of a copular construction (e.g. in **D'ai-tèra noo ne rui** 'She really is a strong one.')
- **ne** cannot be used with pronouns, unlike **ri**
- **ri** marks the subject of a transitive verb (this is called *ergative case*)
- if there is a possessor, the order is Possessed Possessor
 - so **ngidi dahi**, lit. *edge sea* = *the edge of the sea*

Prepositional Phrases:

- the order is Preposition NounPhrase

Adverbs:

- **d'ai-tèra** goes to the left of what it modifies

- **na** = 3SG, *she* (or *he*), *her* (or *his*)
- **ra** = 3PL, *they*, *their*

Noun Phrases:

- no visible case-marking
- if there is a possessor, the order is Possessed Possessor
 - so **kètu na**, lit. *head 3SG* = *her head*

Prepositional Phrases:

- the order is Preposition NounPhrase

Adverbs:

- **titu-kèna** goes to the right of what it modifies

Note: in Dhao, the word meaning *if* is **ladhe**, the same as the word **ladhe**, which also means *see*. This illustrates the process known as *syntactic change*. The word **ladhe** was probably originally just a verb, but speakers reinterpreted it to also mean *if* and to serve a different grammatical function.